



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES
August 19, 2025

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:36 p.m. by Mayor Daniel J. Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Mayor Mahoney.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Christy Davis, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: none.

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, City Assessor Jason Yoakam, Director of Parks and Recreation Kelli Hoover, Chief Equity Officer John Willis, Police Chief Chris Simpson, Director of Community Development Shane LaPorte, and City Engineer Troy White.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn, to adopt the agenda. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS: none.

PUBLIC HEARINGS: none.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

- A. Minutes of the July 22, 2025, Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council**
Approve the minutes of the July 22, 2025 Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council.
- B. Alley Vacation Receipt - Wesley to Franklin**
Receipt of alley vacation petition and refer to staff for recommendation
- C. City of Jackson, Michigan Preliminary Financial Statements for the Twelve Months Ended June 30, 2025**
- D. Special Event Application: Commonwealth's International Dog Day**
Approve a request from Commonwealth Associates, Inc. to host the Commonwealth's International Dog Day on August 21, 2025, at Horace Blackman Park in downtown Jackson.
- E. Special Event Application: Ruck to Remember Veteran Suicide**
Approve a request from the Jackson County Military Coalition to host the Ruck to Remember Veteran Suicide on September 6, 2025, in downtown Jackson.
- F. Special Event Application: Grand River Annual Cleanup**
Approve a request from the Grand River Environmental Action Team to host the Grand River Annual Cleanup on September 13, 2025, in downtown Jackson.
- G. Special Event Application: K105.3 Fall Fest & Chili Classic**
Approve a request from the McKibbin Media Group to host the K105.3 Fall Fest & Chili Classic on September 27, 2025, in downtown Jackson.
- H. Special Event Application: ORS Oktoberfest 10L5K Kids Superhero Run**
Approve a request from the Orthopaedic Rehab Specialists to host the ORS Oktoberfest 10K/5K Kids Superhero Run on October 4, 2025, in downtown Jackson
- I. Special Event Application: Grand River Farmers Market**
Approve a request from the Jackson DDA to host the Grand River Farmers Market Tuesdays through October 2025, in downtown Jackson.

J. Special Event Application: Jackson High Homecoming Parade

Approve a request from Jackson Public School to host the Jackson High Homecoming Parade on September 26, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

K. Special Event Application: Jackson Civil War Muster 2025

Approve a request from the Jackson Civil War Society to host the Jackson Civil War Muster on August 22-24, 2025, at Cascades in Jackson.

L. Special Event Application: Public Rosary

Approve a request from the Queen of the Miraculous Medal Church to host the Public Rosary on October 12, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

M. Special Event Application: Fire in the City

Approve a request from Found Church to host Fire in the City on September 26, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

N. Special Event Application: Workers Rights Celebration and Rally

Approve a request from the Local Community Advocates & Jackson County Democratic Committee to host the Workers' Rights Celebration and Rally on September 1, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave, to approve the consent calendar. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS: none.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. City Treasurer Position

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn, to establish August 26, 2025, at 6:00 p.m. as the time and date for the Treasurer's interviews. Vote was done by voice with all in favor.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn, to direct the City Attorney to prepare a resolution proposing a charter amendment to change the City Treasurer position from an elected position to a City Council appointed position after December 1, 2028. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. Opioid Settlement Funds

Recommendation: *Authorize the issuance of a Request for Proposals (RFP) for the Grant for Substance Use Disorder (SUD) Treatment and Transitional Housing, funded by opioid settlement proceeds.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood, to authorize the issuance of a Request for Proposals for the Grant for Substance Use Disorder Treatment and Transitional Housing, funded by opioid settlement proceeds. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Accelerate Jackson Professional Services Contract

Recommendation: *Approve a \$50,000 annual fee-for-service agreement with Accelerate Jackson County (AJC) to provide targeted economic development services to the City of Jackson, including business retention, property marketing, redevelopment facilitation, and strategic planning support.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Wood, to approve a \$50,000 annual fee-for-service agreement with Accelerate Jackson County to provide targeted economic development services to the City of Jackson, including business retention, property marketing, redevelopment facilitation, and strategic planning support. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Abstain: Davis (1). Motion carried.

Councilmember Davis stated she abstained from the vote due to a campaign donation

D. Resolution: LOCC Recommendation - Mayor

Recommendation: *Consider the recommendation made by the Local Officers Compensation Commission and adopt the resolution either by accepting the recommendation (Option A) or rejecting the recommendation (Option B).*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave, to adopt Option A resolution.

Councilmember Wood and Forgrave withdrew the motion.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to reject the recommendation of the LOCC. Vote – Yeas: Councilmembers Wood and Davis (2). Nays: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, and Forgrave (5). Motion failed.

E. Resolution: LOCC Recommendation - City Treasurer

Recommendation: *Consider the recommendation of the Local Officers Compensation Commission and adopt a resolution to either accept the recommendation (Option A Resolution) or to reject the recommendation (Option B Resolution).*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn, to reject the recommendation of the LOCC. Vote – Yeas: Councilmembers Gunn and Davis (2). Nays: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, and Forgrave (5). Motion failed.

F. Resolution: LOCC Recommendation - City Council

Recommendation: *Consider the recommendation made by the Local Officers Compensation Commission as it pertains to the salary for members of City Council and adopt either the resolution to accept the recommendation (Option A) or to reject the recommendation (Option B).*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Wood, to reject the recommendation of the LOCC. Vote – Yeas: Councilmembers Davis and Forgrave (2). Nays: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood (5). Motion failed.

G. Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Replacement Contract – Change Order

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 1 to the Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Replacement contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc. in the decreased amount of \$174,928.33 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson, to approve Change Order 1 to the Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Replacement contract with Bailey Excavating in the decreased amount of \$174,928.33 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

H. Water Treatment Plant Source Water Study Professional Services Contract

Recommendation: *Approval for the Professional Services Contract with Spalding DeDecker to perform the Engineering for the Water Treatment Source Water Study for \$499,998.00*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn, to approve the Professional Services Contract with Spalding DeDecker to perform the Engineering for the Water Treatment Source Water Study for

\$499,998.00. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

I. Region 2 Planning Commission Invoice

Recommendation: *Approve a Local Funding Resolution and payment in the amount of \$28,540.00 to Region 2 Planning Commission for the City of Jackson's share of the cost of the Jackson Area Comprehensive Transportation Study (JACTS) Unified Work Program for FY 2025 and authorize the City Engineer to sign the Local Funding Resolution.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn, to approve a Local Funding Resolution and payment in the amount of \$28,540.00 to Region 2 Planning Commission for the City of Jackson's share of the cost of the Jackson Area Comprehensive Transportation Study Unified Work Program for FY 2025 and authorize the City Engineer to sign the Local Funding Resolution. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

J. Budget Amendment

Recommendation: *Approve a budget amendment to reallocate \$300,000 from the General Fund to the Building Demolition Fund.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood, to approve a budget amendment to reallocate \$300,000 from the General Fund to the Building Demolition Fund. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

K. 2025 Major Street Engineering Contract -Amendment 1

Recommendation: *Approve Amendment 1 to the 25-001 Major Street Engineering contract with Hubbell, Roth & Clark, Inc. (HRC) of Jackson, MI, at a not-to-exceed cost of \$66,660.00, and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to sign the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn, to approve Amendment 1 to the 25-001 Major Street Engineering contract with Hubbell, Roth & Clark of Jackson, MI, at a not-to-exceed cost of \$66,660.00, and authorize the City Manager and Engineer to sign the appropriate document. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to take a three minute recess. Vote was done by voice with all in favor.

Recess was taken from 7:57 p.m. until 8:01 p.m.

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to return to session. Vote was done by voice with all in favor.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER'S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave all offered comments.

MANAGER'S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Green offered comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Davis. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 8:25 p.m.